In Provence, they say *aïgo boulido sauvo la vido*—"garlic broth saves your life." Ten cloves of garlic go into this dish, yet it is not terrifyingly garlicky.

garlic broth

SERVES 4 **PREP** 15 MINS **COOK** 20 MINS **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

10 garlic cloves, crushed
6 sage leaves
1 bay leaf
1 large sprig of thyme
2 tbsp extra virgin olive oil, plus extra to drizzle
1 quart (1 liter) water or light chicken stock
salt and freshly ground black pepper
8 croûtes (see p39)
1 garlic clove, halved (optional)
3 egg yolks
grated Gruyère, to serve

1 Put the garlic into a saucepan with the sage, bay leaf, thyme, oil, water or stock, and some salt and freshly ground black pepper. Bring to a boil, then simmer gently for 15 minutes. Meanwhile, rub one side of each croûte with the cut clove of garlic, if using, and place two in each bowl. Drizzle a little oil over each one.

2 Turn off the heat and pick out and discard the bay leaf and thyme (but not the sage). Whisk 3 tbsp of the hot soup into the egg yolks, then pour everything back into the pan and stir. Taste and adjust the seasoning, then transfer the soup to a hot tureen. Ladle the soup into the bowls and serve at once, passing around the Gruyère for topping.



GARLIC
The flavor of garlic differs according to how you prepare it. Left whole and boiled, it tastes mild and sweet. When you chop it, its flavor intensifies, and the more finely it's chopped, the more pungent it becomes.